

Got Moles Phone Role-Play Pack

Twenty scenarios. Tiers 1–3 are built from real recorded calls (April–July 2026) — every opening line is something an actual caller said. Tier 4 (added 2026-07-27) is the curveball stack: harder calls that test what Muhammad actually knows about moles and about how we work, not just whether he can recite the price sheet. Use this pack two ways:

- **Live with Spencer:** Spencer plays the caller, Muhammad answers as Got Moles. Run 2–3 scenarios per session, debrief after each.
- **Solo with Claude:** say "**phone role-play**" in a Claude session — Claude plays the caller, stays in character, then scores the call and tracks progress.

Facilitator rules (Spencer): don't rescue him mid-call — let a bad answer play out, the debrief is where teaching happens. Stay in character, including the awkward pauses and repeated questions real callers ask. One curveball per rep at first; stack them as he improves. Pass = he'd have won or correctly handled the caller for real.

Scoring every rep (100 pts): Accuracy on pricing/policy 30 · Script arc & qualifying questions 20 · Education & objection handling 20 · Info capture (name, cell, email, address, "how did you find us?") 15 · Tone 15. Passing = 80+.

Tier 1 — Bread and butter (master these first)

1. The price shopper

Caller: Ron, Normandy Park. Retired, direct, zero small talk. **Opens with:** *"I'm trying to get a quote — like, roughly, what is your pricing on getting rid of a mole?"* **Wants:** a number, fast. Resists the discovery questions. **Curveball:** "Just give me the number, I don't need the sales pitch." **Pass:** gives both options cleanly anyway, gets at least location + property size + mole history in before quoting, doesn't chase when the caller says "I'll call around" — holds price, leaves the door open warmly. **Common mistake:** quoting \$450 with no context so it sounds expensive, or discounting unprompted to save the sale.

2. Dog, kids, and traps

Caller: Rachel, Puyallup. Warm but anxious. Two kids (8, 10) and a golden retriever. **Opens with:** *"We do have a dog — do I need to worry about these traps with my dog?"* **Wants:** safety reassurance more than mole facts. **Curveball:** "How big are the traps? I don't want the animals getting their foot chopped off." Then: "What do you do with the moles when you catch them?" **Pass:** covered/staked/bucket-over-trap explanation, "tell the kids don't touch," chemical-free framing, and the disposal answer — **double-bagged into YOUR garbage can; we take it with us only on request.** Never gets graphic. **Common mistake:** dodging the death question. Callers respect matter-of-fact honesty.

3. "Is that per mole?"

Caller: Anne, Federal Way. Careful with money, re-asks the same question different ways. **Opens with:** *"It says if we catch them, 150 to start, 450 max — is that per mole?"* **Wants:** to not get surprise-billed. **Curveball:** "If you catch two moles it's a \$300 balance. If you catch five moles it's a \$300 balance?" (asks

literally this, twice) **Pass:** flat-rate explanation lands: *"From one to a million moles, the price doesn't go up or down"* — plus the trust angle (per-mole trappers have an incentive to inflate the count) and the guarantee (\$150 is all you pay if nothing's caught). **Common mistake:** explaining it once and moving on. This caller needs it confirmed two or three times — patience IS the skill.

4. Voles, not moles

Caller: Bill, Maple Valley. Chatty, unsure what he's got. **Opens with:** *"I'm pretty sure they're voles. Y'all trap those too?"* **Wants:** any help at all. **Curveball:** describes "a hundred tiny one-inch holes in the mulch" — definitely voles. Then: *"So you don't know anybody who does voles?"* **Pass:** teaches the ID rule (**mounds or raised tunnels = moles; small open holes and grass streaks = voles**), offers photo ID by text to the business cell (NOT the ad tracking number), and refers out honestly (Trapline / traplineproducts.com for DIY) instead of stretching for the sale. **Common mistake:** booking a visit "just in case" — an honest no earns referrals; a wasted visit earns a refund.

5. "What time will you be here?"

Caller: Lynn, existing customer, Auburn. Friendly but needs to leave at 3pm. **Opens with:** *"Just trying to see if you have an ETA today."* **Wants:** an exact time you cannot give. **Curveball:** "Can you just tell him to come before noon?" Then: *"Do I need to be home?"* **Pass:** never invents a time. Gives the real flow — quote approved → route optimized → **email day-before, text morning-of, text en-route** — and the unlock: nobody needs to be home, just leave the gate open. **Common mistake:** promising "probably morning" to be nice. That promise becomes tomorrow's angry no-show call.

Tier 2 — Judgment calls

6. The DIY veteran

Caller: Gary, Shoreline. Five years of fighting moles himself. Skeptical of everyone. **Opens with:** *"I've got a T-handled poison injector that doesn't do squat. I spent \$20 on those stupid poison worms and now I have MORE mounds."* **Wants:** to know why you'd succeed where he failed. **Curveball:** "Why would your traps work when nothing else has?" **Pass:** validates instead of mocking (*"that stuff doesn't work — this industry is full of gimmicks"*), explains WHY poison fails (moles smell chemicals; they eat live worms — the wagyu-vs-Beyond-Meat line), and pivots to the worm-supply education. Skeptics convert when the explanation makes them feel smart, not dumb. **Common mistake:** leading with "you wasted your money."

7. "They're back!"

Caller: Dana, Federal Way. Used Got Moles last year. Cheerful but exasperated. **Opens with:** *"Well, I've got some moles again. I think you helped me last year."* **Wants:** the same fix, quick. **Curveball:** "Didn't we already pay you to get rid of them? Why are they back?" **Pass:** frames return as expected, not failure — territorial moles, vacant tunnel network, *"not if but when."* Offers the returning-customer month (\$375) AND makes the annual-plan case ("if you're calling me every year, \$100/month makes more sense"). Books fast. **Common mistake:** getting defensive about the previous job.

8. The price-sensitive senior

Caller: Colleen, Tacoma. On fixed income, comparing you to Mole Masters. Long calls, lots of life detail.

Opens with: *"I cannot afford \$125 every month. The other company said \$395 for a one-time service."*

Wants: to be taken seriously and not upsold. **Curveball:** "Do you offer any senior discounts?" and later, "I need to think about it and call my daughter." **Pass:** patience with the tangents, honest comparison without trashing the competitor, uses real discount latitude (senior rate, returning-customer pricing) rather than inventing numbers, and lets her leave without pressure while securing the callback info. **Common mistake:** rushing her, or promising a discount Spencer hasn't authorized. Know the latitude before the call.

9. Contract-wary

Caller: Deb, Sammamish. Wants the annual plan but scared of commitment. **Opens with:** *"What if there was a financial situation where we'd maybe have to cancel? Is that an option?"* **Wants:** the honest fine print.

Curveball: "So I'm just checking — there's no forced yearly contract?" (there is a 12-month commitment — don't fudge it) **Pass:** states terms plainly: 12-month commitment, auto-renews month-to-month after, early exit = 50% of remainder, billed last day of month, no deposit. Then reframes value: *"\$3 a day, whole year."* Offers the Quick Fix bridge (\$150 setup credits toward annual) if she's still nervous.

Common mistake: mumbling past the cancellation fee. Hiding it loses the trust that closes these calls.

10. Out of area

Caller: Mike, Everett. Nice guy, real mole problem, wrong county. **Opens with:** *"I am in Everett, Washington — do you service this area?"* **Wants:** help; will settle for a direction. **Curveball:** "Is there any flexibility at all? What if we come mow your lawn for a couple years?" (a real Vashon caller offered this)

Pass: clean no with a warm referral — Kirk at Northwest Mole King for north sound, Terry Cotton for Kitsap — and DIY guidance (Trapline traps) where nobody serves them. Caller should hang up liking the company. **Common mistake:** a bare "no, sorry, bye." Referrals cost nothing and these callers leave five-star reviews anyway.

11. The spouse deferral

Caller: Priya, Sammamish. Fully sold, but not the decision-maker. **Opens with:** *"Let me forward this to my husband to see which option to go with."* **Wants:** an exit without committing. **Curveball:** if pushed hard, she goes cold and vague.

Pass: doesn't push — sends the quote to BOTH spouses (get the second email/phone), sets a concrete follow-up ("I'll check back tomorrow afternoon if I haven't heard"), and plants one sentence for the dinner conversation (flat rate + nothing-caught guarantee). **Common mistake:** treating it as a rejection and letting the lead die, or closing so hard she stops answering.

Tier 3 — Hard mode

12. The no-show

Caller: Richard, existing customer. Second call of the morning. Polite words, hot tone. **Opens with:** *"Spencer was supposed to come yesterday, but he didn't show up, didn't send me any text. I just don't know what's going on."* **Wants:** acknowledgment first, a fix second.

Curveball: "This is the second time I've called about this today. Is anyone actually going to call me back?" **Pass:** apologize without excuses,

own it on behalf of the company, reschedule to a concrete day RIGHT NOW on the call, and promise (then flag) the proactive-text fix. No blaming the router, the tech, or the system. **Common mistake:** explaining why it happened before acknowledging it happened.

13. The property manager

Caller: Janet, The Management Trust (HOA). All business, unfamiliar vocabulary. **Opens with:** *"I need bids on mole abatement for three townhouse units, and we'll need you set up as a compliant vendor — COI, W-9, the usual."* **Wants:** paperwork competence and a time window she can give her board.

Curveball: "Can you be out there this week? The board meets Thursday." **Pass:** doesn't fake answers — captures exactly what's needed (units, addresses, compliance docs, deadline, billing contact), sets expectations honestly, and routes to Spencer same-day with a complete note. Knowing what you DON'T handle is the pass condition. **Common mistake:** quoting residential pricing at a commercial job, or promising vendor paperwork sight-unseen.

14. The legality challenge

Caller: Tom, Burien. Genuinely curious, slightly confrontational. **Opens with:** *"Oh, so you're actually allowed to kill them? I didn't think in Washington we were allowed to."* **Wants:** to check you're legit.

Curveball: "I read there was some law about trapping in Washington." **Pass:** uses Spencer's framing exactly — pest-control trapping is legal; the restrictions people remember concern fur-trapping of furbearers — delivered calm and unrattled (Spencer answers this five times a day). Bridges back to chemical-free, safe-for-pets professional methods. **No claims beyond that framing.** **Common mistake:** improvising legal commentary or getting defensive. Stick to the script.

15. The callback (outbound — hardest rep)

Setup: Muhammad calls OUT to a lead the AI intake captured yesterday. The AI logged the address wrong ("3302 Bond Road" — caller said 302, twice, and hung up swearing). The lead has since gotten a competitor quote. **Caller answers with:** *"Oh — yeah, I called you guys yesterday. Honestly your machine kind of screwed up my address twice, and Mole Masters already called me back."* **Pass:** opens with the fix ("I've got you at 302 Bond Road — is that right?"), apologizes for the machine briefly without dwelling, leads with what the caller was blocked on (pricing + when we can come), and offers speed as the differentiator. Re-verifies EVERY detail the AI captured. **Common mistake:** launching into the standard inbound script on an outbound call, or bad-mouthing the competitor.

Tier 4 — Curveball stack (mole knowledge under fire)

Added 2026-07-27. These five stack two to four curveballs per call and are scored the same way, with one addition: **a confident wrong fact about moles costs more than "I don't know, let me get you the exact answer from Spencer."** Bluffing is a fail even when the guess happens to be right. Answer key for the biology is at the bottom of this pack.

16. Catch and release

Caller: Marisol, Issaquah. Soft-spoken, moral framing, and sharper than she sounds. She has done reading. **Opens with:** *"Before we go any further — do you kill them? Because I'd want them relocated, not killed."* **Wants:** to hire someone she doesn't feel bad about hiring. **Curveballs, in this order:** 1)

"Can't you just live-trap them and drop them at a park?" 2) "I'm fairly sure Washington voted to ban those kill traps — Initiative 713. So how is what you do legal?" 3) "Then just tell me exactly what kind of trap you use and I'll look it up myself." **Pass:** leads with what we *are* — chemical-free, no poisons or gas, safe for pets and kids, professional trapping — so nothing goes into her yard or near her animals. Answers the relocation question honestly and without drama: moles are solitary and territorial, so a mole dropped into ground another mole already owns doesn't survive, and it makes the problem someone else's; we don't haul wildlife around the county. On the legality push, uses Spencer's framing **only** — pest-control trapping is legal; the restrictions people remember concern fur-trapping of furbearers — then bridges back to methods. When she presses for trap specifics or keeps litigating the law, hands it to Spencer and captures the callback. **The trap he must not spring:** we do **not** claim I-713 compliance, we do **not** argue that the initiative "doesn't apply to us," and we do **not** narrate trap mechanics. Any of those is an automatic hard-gate fail. Matter-of-fact is required; graphic is not the same as matter-of-fact — "it snaps their spine" loses this caller and violates the tone standard both. **Common mistake:** trying to win the ethics argument. She isn't asking to be debated, she's asking whether we're the kind of company that's straight with her. Honest disqualification is an acceptable outcome here; a legal claim is not.

17. The landscaper crossfire

Caller: Trevor, Sumner. New build, talks fast, \$14K of sod going down Thursday. **Opens with:** *"My landscaper says if I just do a grub treatment the moles will leave. Is that true, or is he blowing smoke?"* **Wants:** the cheapest thing that works before Thursday. **Curveballs:** 1) "So I'll do the grub control and skip you, right?" 2) "Sod goes in Thursday — can you come Saturday once it's down?" 3) "Won't your traps tear up brand-new sod?" **Pass:** the food-supply answer, which is the whole conversion — **earthworms are the staple; grubs are a side dish.** Grub treatments kill grubs; nothing kills earthworms, so the food source and the mole both stay. Then the sequencing: trap **first, then** landscape — laying sod over an active tunnel network buys fresh mounds in a brand-new lawn, and new sod gets watered hard, which pulls worms up (*"you basically rang the dinner bell"*). No weekend visits — M–F only — so offers Thursday or Friday and pushes to get in **before** the sod. Traps go into existing runs, covered and staked, not dug at random. Gives the prep instruction: knock the mounds down, mow, leave it a couple of days so fresh activity shows. Still runs the arc — residential, acreage, how long he's had them — before quoting. **Common mistake:** hedging with "the grub treatment might help as a first step" to sound agreeable. That sentence loses the job and costs him money. Second mistake: saying yes to Saturday.

18. Four visits, no moles

Caller: Denise, Bonney Lake. Quick Fix customer, week 4 of 5, \$150 deposit paid. Cold and businesslike, which is worse than shouting. **Opens with:** *"Your guy has been out four times and hasn't caught a single mole. I've got a new mound this morning. What exactly am I paying for?"* **Wants:** to stop feeling like she got taken. **Curveballs:** 1) "So do I get my \$150 back or not?" 2) "How do I even know he's been here?" 3) "If I don't get a straight answer I'll dispute the charge with my bank and put this on Google." **Pass:** acknowledges before explaining, then gets the guarantee out early because **the guarantee is the good news** — if nothing is caught, the \$150 setup is all she pays; the balance only comes due on a job that catches. Handles the new mound as a diagnostic, not a defense: fresh mounds are dark, damp, crumbly soil; old ones are crusted and flat — knock them down so we can read what's actually new. Explains without excusing: it's usually one mole, it patrols a tunnel network, and a trap set in an active run waits for it. Then escalates properly — pulls the tech's visit notes, gets Spencer on it **today**, gives a specific callback time and keeps it. Never invents a refund or a credit; says plainly that Spencer makes that call and that he'll hear it from him today. **Common mistake:** defending the tech before acknowledging her, or blurting "we'll

refund you" to make the anger stop. Both cost more than they save — the first escalates her, the second commits Spencer's money.

19. It's coming from the field behind me

Caller: Hank, Enumclaw. Two acres backing onto a greenbelt and a horse pasture. Friendly, stubborn, wants this solved permanently. **Opens with:** *"I can trap all day in my yard, but they're marching in from the field behind me. Can't you just go set some traps back there?"* **Wants:** the source shut off.

Curveballs: 1) "Nobody's going to know. It's just a greenbelt." 2) "So you're telling me I'll be paying you forever?" 3) "Two of my neighbors have the same problem — what do you do about that?" 4) mentions, in passing, that there are horses in the pasture next door. **Pass:** clean no on trapping ground we don't have permission for, and protected greenbelts are off-limits — delivered as professionalism, not as rule-quoting. Then redirects to what actually works: perimeter trapping along his line plus ongoing coverage. This is the purest annual-plan case in the pack — a re-invasion corridor is *"not if, but when"* in its most literal form, so **Total Mole Control at the 1–3 acre tier (\$125/mo)**, not a Quick Fix he'll be re-invaded out of by fall. Answers "forever?" honestly: the moles next door aren't going away, so this is maintenance, not a failed cure — \$3-something a day for a yard that stays flat. Picks up the neighbor thread (group rates: \$85 each for two yards, \$75 for three; referral = a free month). Logs the livestock as a hazard note **before** anything gets scheduled. **Common mistake:** selling him the Quick Fix because it's the easier yes, or agreeing to "just take a look" at the greenbelt.

20. The gauntlet

Caller: Alan, Gig Harbor. Retired science teacher. Pleasant, relentless, no transitions between questions. He will buy from whoever convinces him they know the animal. Two of his questions contain false premises. **Opens with:** *"Before I hire anybody — humor me. How much do you actually know about moles?"* **The gauntlet** (fire them in order; don't wait for a perfect answer before moving on):

1. "I've got about thirty mounds. How many moles is that?"
2. "They're rodents, right?" ← **false premise**
3. "Are they blind?"
4. "Do they hibernate? Should I just wait until winter?"
5. "They're eating my hosta roots." ← **false premise**
6. "How much does one eat?"
7. "What are all those tunnels actually for?"
8. "Honestly — aren't moles good for the soil?"
9. "Then why did I get a fresh mound the day after the last guy trapped one?"

Curveball: at some point, whatever he answers, say *"You're guessing on that one, aren't you?"* The right response to a question he doesn't know is *"I don't know — I'll get you the exact answer from Spencer,"* then actually capture the callback. Bluffing is a fail even if the guess is correct. **Pass:** at least 7 of 9 right, **both** false premises caught without making him feel stupid (*"that's the common one — they're insectivores, closer to a shrew than a rat, which is exactly why the poison worms people buy don't work on them"*), and — the part he'll actually fail — he **converts the education into the sale**. Worm supply → nothing removes the food → that's why trapping is the only thing that works → acreage, how long you've had them, both options, name, cell, email, address, "how did you find me?" **Common mistake:** enjoying the

conversation and never asking for the job. Alan will happily talk for twenty minutes and hang up unbooked, and he'll say nice things about the call while he hires someone else.

Mole knowledge answer key (Tier 4)

General mole biology, and it lines up with how Spencer talks on calls. If a caller pushes past this level of detail, escalate rather than improvise — the phones are not the place to freestyle.

Question	The answer	Why it matters on the phone
How many moles is 30 mounds?	Usually one . Moles are solitary and territorial; a single busy mole builds a lot of mounds. Typically one to a few per acre.	Kills the "I must have an infestation" panic and sets up the flat rate — one mole or a million, the price doesn't move.
Are moles rodents?	No — they're insectivores, related to shrews, not to rats, gophers, or voles.	This is <i>why</i> rodent baits and poison worms fail. Best single fact in the pack.
Are they blind?	Near-blind, not eyeless. Tiny eyes, poor vision; they hunt by touch and smell underground.	Explains why gimmicks aimed at sight or noise do nothing.
Do they hibernate / go away in winter?	No . Active year-round; in cold or dry spells they work deeper runs, so you see fewer fresh mounds.	The most common myth on the phones. "Wait until spring" is how a small problem becomes a big one.
Do they eat plant roots or bulbs?	No . The staple is earthworms, plus grubs and insect larvae. Root and bulb damage is voles; damage from moles is incidental to tunneling.	Caller may have both. It's also the honest-ID moment that earns trust and referrals.
How much do they eat?	Roughly 70% of body weight a day — they can't go long without eating.	Sets up "you can't starve them out."
What are the tunnels for?	A worm net. Deep permanent runs plus shallow feeding tunnels; the mole patrols the runs and eats what falls in. Mounds are the spoil from digging the deep runs.	Explains why traps go in active runs and why the network outlives the mole.
Are moles good for the soil?	Genuinely yes — aeration, and they eat some pest larvae. The problem is the lawn damage and the tunnel network, not the animal.	Conceding this makes everything else more credible.
Why a fresh mound right after one was trapped?	Vacant territory gets claimed — the tunnel network is still there and it's prime real estate. Also, existing runs keep producing spoil.	The single best annual-plan pitch: " <i>not if, but when.</i> "
Fresh mound or old mound?	Fresh = dark, damp, crumbly soil sitting proud. Old = crusted, flattened, weathered.	Turns an angry "it's not working" call into a diagnostic.
Will grub treatment get rid of them?	No. Nothing removes earthworms, so nothing removes the food supply.	Landscapers say this constantly. Don't hedge on it.
Why does watering make it worse?	Irrigation pulls worms up into the top few inches of an irrigated lawn — " <i>you basically rang the dinner bell.</i> "	Explains the summer spike and why the nicest lawn on the street gets hit.
Can you relocate them?	We don't. A mole moved into another mole's territory doesn't survive, and it hands the problem to someone else.	Answer it plainly, no drama, no graphic detail.

Question	The answer	Why it matters on the phone
Is it legal in Washington?	Spencer's framing only: pest-control trapping is legal; the restrictions people remember concern fur-trapping of furbearers. Nothing beyond that sentence. No compliance claims about any initiative. Press it further → Spencer.	Hard gate. This is the one place where "I'll have Spencer call you" is a better answer than a confident one.

Rapid-fire drill (5 minutes, any session)

Fire these back-to-back; each answer in under 20 seconds, accurate:

1. How much does it cost? · 2. Is that per mole? · 3. What if you don't catch anything? · 4. How soon can you come? · 5. What time will you be here? · 6. Do I need to be home? · 7. Is it safe for my dog? · 8. Do you use poison? · 9. Are these moles or voles? · 10. Can I cancel the annual plan? · 11. Do you service [Everett / Vashon / Kenmore]? (three different answers!) · 12. Do moles go away in winter? · 13. How many moles do I have? · 14. What do you do with them after? · 15. Is this even legal in Washington? · 16. Any discounts? · 17. Do you do weekends? · 18. Can someone come look first? · 19. How do I pay? · 20. Why did they come back after you trapped one?

Mole facts drill (5 minutes — the knowledge half)

Same rules, but these test the animal, not the price sheet. Under 20 seconds each, and **"I'll get that exact answer from Spencer" beats a confident guess.**

1. Are moles rodents? · 2. What do they eat? · 3. Do they eat plant roots? · 4. How much do they eat in a day? · 5. Are they blind? · 6. Do they hibernate? · 7. Thirty mounds — how many moles? · 8. Why do the mounds keep coming after you trap one? · 9. What's the difference between a fresh mound and an old one? · 10. Will a grub treatment get rid of them? · 11. Why doesn't poison work? · 12. Why do they get worse when I water? · 13. What are the tunnels actually for? · 14. Mole, vole, or gopher — how do I tell? · 15. Can you relocate them instead? · 16. Do moles do anything good? · 17. Do they come inside the house? (no — they live underground; it's a lawn problem, not a home-invasion one) · 18. Is it legal in Washington? · 19. Should I wait until winter? · 20. Do I have one mole or an infestation?

Progression plan

- **Week 1:** Tier 1 only + rapid-fire daily. Pass all five twice before moving on.
- **Week 2:** Tier 2, one new scenario per day, re-run any Tier 1 that scored under 90.
- **Week 3:** Tier 3 + curveball stacking (two per call) + outbound callback reps.
- **Week 4:** Tier 4 + the mole facts drill daily. Run #20 (the gauntlet) cold before anything else — it exposes exactly which facts aren't solid yet, and the rest of the tier gets easier once they are.
- **Ongoing:** one random scenario per week, cold. When a real call goes sideways, turn it into scenario #21, #22, ... — this pack should grow.

Companion doc: `2026-07-20_muhammad-faq-training.md` (the answer key for every scenario above). Real transcripts: `data/calls.jsonl` .